YOUR FIELD GUIDE

A repeatable image. A useful record.

A practical companion to six modules, 12 lessons and a final assessment. Allow three to four hours with the exercises. Keep this workbook alongside the course player.

START HERE: Work on a dental model, mannequin or other non-patient training subject. No patient images or identifying information belong in this workbook.

What you will make

01 A setup card

Record the camera, subject, lighting and geometry so another person can repeat the session.

02 A quality checklist

Find the cause of a weak image and choose one corrective action.

03 A five-view practice portfolio

Keep the originals, select a consistent series and explain one improvement.

Your name or training alias / practice date

How to complete the course

Read each lesson, perform its exercise and record your findings. Mark the lesson complete in the player. The final quiz has 16 questions, an 80% pass mark (at least 13 correct) and three attempts. Portfolio work is self-reviewed; the platform does not inspect or grade photographs.

Review edition: academy clinical review, local policy approval and faculty attribution are pending. This course does not establish clinical competence or accredited continuing-education credit. Use qualified supervision and academy-approved procedures before applying a workflow with patients.

MODULES 01-02

Build your setup card.

Make the session reproducible before trying to make the image beautiful. Use this sheet for every practice series.

FIELD	YOUR BASELINE
Training subject / intended view	
Camera / lens / focal length	
Exposure mode / ISO / aperture / shutter	
Light source / position / power	
White balance / reference / colour handling	
Camera position / working distance / framing	
Focus target / orientation / file format	
File destination / naming / original preservation	

What must stay fixed when you repeat this series?

Record what you actually used. There is no single camera setting that fits every device, lens, light or subject. Test the setup on the model, then review the result at useful magnification.

MODULE 02

Change one variable.

Use a textured model or printed object. Fix the camera and subject position. Keep a starting frame, change one setting, then explain what changed.

FRAME / CHANGE	WHAT DID YOU OBSERVE?	NEXT ACTION
A / baseline		
B / aperture		
C / shutter or lighting		
D / ISO		

A useful sequence

1. Check brightness without accepting clipped detail.
2. Inspect the intended focus area and the depth of the subject.
3. Check motion blur, noise and reflections separately.
4. Retest one change and compare with the baseline.

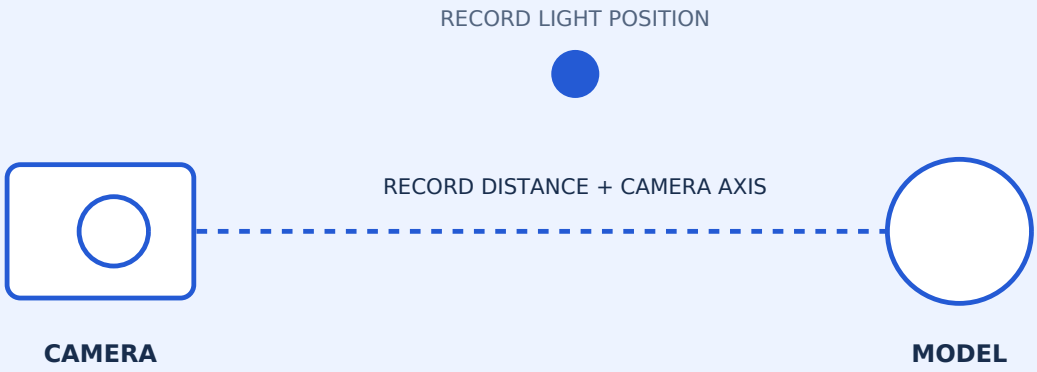
Which adjustment solved the problem? What trade-off did it create?

Aperture affects light and depth of field; shutter time affects ambient exposure and motion; ISO changes amplification and its trade-offs. Flash behaviour depends on the device and synchronisation settings. Consult the equipment manual and practise before a clinical session.

MODULE 03

Make comparisons fair.

Separate a change in the subject from a change in how the photograph was made. Use the sketch as a recording aid, not a prescribed lighting arrangement.



KEEP CONSISTENT	CHECK IN THE NEW FRAME
Subject and camera relationship	Distance, angle, height and rotation
Framing and view	Same intended structures, boundaries and orientation
Light and colour	Direction, power, white balance and references
Processing and file history	Comparable settings and traceable originals

What changed unintentionally between your first and second series?

Do not attribute a difference to treatment or appearance until photographic conditions have been checked. A pleasing image is not necessarily a comparable record.

MODULE 04

Practise a view sequence.

Use a dental model. Decide the orientation and naming convention before starting. Follow the academy-approved clinical protocol only after faculty review.

VIEW	BEFORE YOU KEEP THE FRAME	FILE / OBSERVATION
Frontal model	State the intended coverage. Check alignment and focus.	
Right lateral model	Keep the reference convention. Check intended posterior coverage.	
Left lateral model	Match the opposite view as far as the purpose requires.	
Upper occlusal model	Show the intended arch. Check reflection, visibility and orientation.	
Lower occlusal model	Show the intended arch. Check reflection, visibility and orientation.	

Which view needed a repeat? Name the exact defect and the correction.

Never guess right/left from a reflected image. Preserve the original and document any orientation correction in an authorised working copy. The sequence above is a training exercise, not a universal diagnostic series.

MODULE 05

Use a quality gate.

Rate each selected frame. A zero in any category calls for review before you use the image. This rubric is a learning aid, not a validated clinical score.

CRITERION	0 / REPEAT OR RESOLVE	1 / USABLE WITH NOTE	2 / PURPOSE MET
Purpose / coverage	Intended view missing	Coverage limitation documented	Required area visible
Focus / detail	Key detail unclear	Minor limitation outside key area	Required detail resolved
Exposure / reflections	Key information obscured	Limitation acknowledged	Required detail visible
Geometry / comparison	Misleading or unknown	Difference documented	Setup is reproducible
Identity / orientation	Uncertain or mismatched	Resolved with traceable note	Correct and traceable

DECISION RULE: Do not average away a critical defect. Resolve an uncertain identity or orientation before any clinical use. Retain the original and document the decision.

My weakest category / corrective action / result after repeating

Name the cause before changing the setup: framing, focus, movement, exposure, reflection, colour or file handling. Change one relevant factor and verify the correction.

MODULE 06

Your portfolio capstone.

Make a small, traceable practice set. Allow about 30 minutes after completing the preceding activities. Keep files locally; there is no patient-photo submission in this course.

Your five deliverables

1. Setup card

Complete page 2 with the actual conditions used.

2. View series

Make the five model views on page 5. Use a clear naming convention.

3. Quality review

Apply page 6 to every selected frame. Note limitations honestly.

4. Before / repeat pair

Show one imperfect training frame and the result of one deliberate correction.

5. Short reflection

Explain what worked, what remains uncertain and what you would change next time.

My naming convention and storage location (no patient identifiers)

The correction I can explain and reproduce

Self-review checklist: every deliverable present; originals retained; orientations checked; limitations recorded; no patient data. If a faculty reviewer is available, ask for feedback on the method and the remaining limitations. No portfolio grade is issued by the platform.

FROM PRACTICE TO ROUTINE

Plan the next session.

Use your findings to create a useful routine. Finishing the quiz is one checkpoint; repeatable practice is the continuing task.

One part of my workflow I can now explain to a colleague

One limitation I still need help to resolve

My next practice session: subject, date and one measurable aim

BEFORE WORKING WITH PATIENTS: Confirm the purpose, applicable consent and record rules, infection-control sequence, equipment instructions and authorised storage with the academy. A model exercise does not replace supervised clinical training.

Assessment reminder

Complete the 12 required lessons, then attempt the 16-question post-test. Review your feedback and the relevant lesson before another attempt. If you use all three attempts, the platform supports a reasoned request for an academy-approved retake. This workbook is optional for the platform completion count but supports the practical learning outcomes.

READING & PROVENANCE

Follow the source.

Original teaching exercises and diagrams accompany these primary references. Links open the underlying source. Regional professional standards are contextual examples, not a statement of local law.

01. GDC: Standards for the dental team, confidentiality and images

02. CDC: Dental sterilization and disinfection

03. Nikon: Understanding maximum aperture

04. Nikon: ISO control

05. Nikon: Setting white balance

06. Ahmad: Digital dental photography, Part 5 - lighting

07. Ahmad: Digital dental photography, Part 6 - camera settings

08. Bengel: Standardization in dental photography

09. Claman et al.: Standardized portrait photography for dental patients

10. Ahmad: Digital dental photography, Part 8 - intra-oral set-ups

11. Ong et al.: A standardized approach to extra-oral and intra-oral digital photography

12. Ettorre et al.: Standards for digital photography - basic views and guidelines

13. Bloemen et al.: Development and evaluation of a standardized photography protocol

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